

RESEARCH BRIEFING PACK · AS OF 31 AUGUST 2026

National scholarships, grants, and other education money for Evan Symons

Spring 2027 return to Iowa State University, Finance / Ivy College of Business, after a Fall 2026 stop-out. This pack sits beside the existing ISU-only scholarship files. It does not replace them.

Prepared for	Evan Symons, age 22
Mode	Deep research from official pages only
Overall confidence	MEDIUM-HIGH on process and which programs pay at ISU; LOW on personal SAI/GPA/credits/SAP
Timezone	America/Chicago · claims date-stamped 2026-08-31
Hard no	Iowa Tuition Grant is private-only. Loans are not scholarships. GPA was not invented.

Primary sources: studentaid.gov, fsapartners.ed.gov, educate.iowa.gov (Iowa College Aid), financialaid.iastate.edu, registrar.iastate.edu, carvertrust.org, osherfoundation.org, irs.gov (Pub 970), consumer.ftc.gov. Aggregator listicles and scholarship-mill sweepstakes were not treated as primary.

X/Twitter was not searched in this session. No social posts are invented.

1. Executive summary

The money that actually moves for a 22-year-old returning undergrad with a modest GPA is need-based grants, not national trophy scholarships. File two different FAFSAs on two clocks. Spring 2027 sits in the 2026–27 award year (July 1, 2026 – June 30, 2027). Fall 2027 and after sit in 2027–28.

Do this during the gap (now)

- File the 2026–27 FAFSA at studentaid.gov with ISU school code **001869** if it is not already on file. Federal deadline June 30, 2027; ISU must have a complete file by the last day of Spring 2027 enrollment.
- Check Workday / Admissions (program In-Progress vs Discontinued; offered admission vs not).
- Check StudentAid.gov My Grants (Pell lifetime eligibility used) and loan-servicer status. A stop-out can start the six-month Direct Loan grace.
- Calendar **Tuesday, September 15, 2026** (OneApp 2027–28 opens) and **October 1, 2026** (2027–28 FAFSA opens).
- Use the gap for essay drafts, GPA-recovery planning, and an employer-tuition question. Do not pay anyone to file FAFSA or “guarantee” a scholarship.

Spring 2027 reality check

Iowa’s Workforce Grant FAFSA deadline for 2026–27 was **July 1, 2026 — already passed**. ISU’s ISU Grant / FSEOG / Work-Study 2026–27 priority dates (continuing Jan 6, 2026; transfer March 3, 2026) are also passed. ISU’s published priority-aid policy says late filers are not considered for those pots, but are still considered for **Pell** (if eligible), non-need scholarships, and federal loans. The realistic Spring 2027 free-money path is Pell (prorated for spring-only and enrollment intensity) plus emergency Cyclone Success Assistance once enrolled. The big grant play is **2027–28**.

Iowa programs that do not pay at ISU, or do not fit age 22 / a one-semester stop-out

- **Iowa Tuition Grant** — private Iowa colleges only. Not ISU.
- **Future Ready Iowa Last-Dollar** — Iowa community colleges or accredited private colleges with qualified CTE programs. Not ISU.
- **Kibbie Grant** — Iowa community colleges. Not ISU.
- **Future Ready Iowa Grant** — Iowa resident age 25+ as of July 1 preceding the academic year. Age 22 does not qualify.
- **All Iowa Opportunity Scholarship** — generally recent Iowa high-school graduates who are first-time college freshmen.
- **Osher Reentry Scholarships** — typically a five-or-more-year education gap and ages ~25–50. A one-semester stop-out at 22 does not fit.

Iowa program that does pay at ISU and lists Finance: Iowa Workforce Grant (Regents only). Official 2025–26 / 2026–27 program list updated June 6, 2025 includes Finance, B.S. at ISU. Funded 2026–27 maximum \$1,125 per semester full-time (statutory max \$2,000). Requires Iowa residency, SAI at or below 7,000, at least 60 credits, 3+ credits, FAFSA by July 1. 2026–27 deadline missed. Re-file on time for 2027–28.

National scholarships with no GPA bar or GPA ≤ 2.5 that a 22-year-old returning finance major can actually use are scarce. Most advertised “no essay \$25,000” awards are lotteries, sweepstakes, or profile platforms, not grants. High-GPA national trophies belong on a later-goal watch list only.

2. Key findings

Finding 1 — Spring 2027 is still the 2026–27 FAFSA year. Fall 2027 needs a second FAFSA. Confidence: HIGH

2026–27 award year: July 1, 2026 – June 30, 2027, covering Spring 2027. The 2026–27 FAFSA opened October 1, 2025. Federal receipt deadline June 30, 2027; the college must have correct, complete information by the student’s last day of enrollment. 2027–28 award year: July 1, 2027 – June 30, 2028. ISU OSFA: 2027–28 FAFSA opens October 1, 2026; school code 001869; used for Fall 2027, Spring 2028, Summer 2028. Returning-student priority FAFSA for 2027–28 is January 7, 2027 (ISU Grant, FSEOG, Work-Study). Pell years do not have to be consecutive. Lifetime limit is about six years / 12 full-time semesters. A stop-out does not burn Lifetime Eligibility Used. Check My Grants on StudentAid.gov.

Finding 2 — Pell is the only federal grant still realistically in play for Spring 2027 if campus priority dates were missed. Confidence: HIGH on rules; LOW on Evan’s SAI

Maximum Pell 2026–27 is \$7,395; minimum \$740 (ED GEN-26-01, confirmed Feb 18, 2026 under P.L. 119-75). 2027–28 maximum is not yet published (StudentAid.gov: early 2027). Pell is need-based, not merit-based — no 3.0 GPA floor — but ISU SAP still applies (2.0 cumulative GPA, 67% pace, 150% timeframe). Spring-only enrollment is prorated by enrollment intensity; a student enrolled only in spring receives the spring payment period, not a full-year check. For 2026–27, an SAI equal to or greater than \$14,790 (twice max Pell) cannot receive Pell except Special Rule cases. FSEOG is campus-based and first-come after ISU’s priority; an ED fact sheet dated June 2022 still lists “up to \$4,000 a year” — treat the current campus max as unpublished. Missed 2026–27 ISU priority means FSEOG and Work-Study are not considered; a non-FWS job is still possible.

Finding 3 — Almost no Iowa state grant pays a 22-year-old Finance major at ISU in Spring 2027. Confidence: HIGH

Program	Pays at ISU?	Fit now
Iowa Workforce Grant	Yes — Regents only	Not 2026–27 (Jul 1, 2026 missed). High for 2027–28 if resident, Finance B.S., ≥60 cr, SAI ≤7,000. Funded \$1,125/sem FT in 2026–27.
Iowa Tuition Grant	No — private only	None. Official: eligible private colleges.
Last-Dollar	No — CC / private CTE	Certificates, diplomas, associate degrees. Not ISU.
Kibbie Grant	No — Iowa CCs	Career/technical at community colleges. 2026–27 max \$3,100.
Future Ready Iowa Grant	Yes if age 25+	None at 22. Age 25 as of July 1 preceding the year.
All Iowa Opportunity	Eligible Iowa colleges	None as a 22-year-old returning student. First-time freshman / recent HS. 2026–27 max \$5,486; Apr 1, 2026 passed.
Robert D. Blue	Yes — any Iowa college	Medium. \$500–\$1,000; May 31; essay/need; evaluates HS GPA.

Table. Iowa programs vs a public-university Finance returner. As of 2026-08-31.

Finding 4 — ISU Grant, OneApp, SAP, and reentry are separate machines. OneApp 2027–28 does not fund Spring 2027. Confidence: HIGH on calendars; MEDIUM on one-semester reentry

ISU Grant is institutional need-based; amount unpublished. 2026–27 priority already passed. 2027–28 returning priority is January 7, 2027. OneApp (iastate.academicworks.com) opens September 15, 2026 for the 2027–2028 scholarship year — Fall 2027 / Spring 2028 / Summer 2028 money, not a Spring 2027 check. Must be offered admission to log in. Cyclone Success Assistance (emergency/completion) is via OneApp after enrollment, about one week processing. SAP: 2.0 GPA, 67% pace, 150% timeframe; withdrawal can trigger Warning; Failed SAP needs an appeal. A stop-out does not reset SAP. Reentry is required when not enrolled for the previous two academic terms (excluding summer) and/or the record is Discontinued. A single skipped Fall 2026 may not require reentry if the program is still In-Progress in Workday. Academic dismissal is reinstatement; Spring 2027 petition deadline December 4, 2026. Half-time is 6–8.5 undergraduate credits in fall/spring. Direct Loans need half-time. Pell can pay below half-time, prorated. Workforce Grant: at least 3 credits.

Finding 5 — Incoming CC-transfer / PTK awards that need “full-time immediately after a two-year college” are likely dead after this gap. Confidence: HIGH on terms

The companion ISU-only pack (same day) documents the Community College Transfer Scholarship (\$500–\$2,000) and PTK Member Scholarship (\$2,000/year × 2) as requiring full-time immediately after a two-year college, plus GPA 3.00 / 3.50. A Fall 2026 stop-out then Spring 2027 ISU start is not “immediately after” community college. Do not budget these. If he is already an ISU student returning, they were never his.

Finding 6 — National scholarships a modest-GPA 22-year-old can actually apply for are few. Confidence: HIGH on scarcity and FTC scam patterns

Can apply without a high GPA (or with a published floor ≤ 2.8): Pell / FSEOG / Work-Study / ISU Grant / Iowa Workforce Grant (need, SAP ~2.0); Robert D. Blue (\$500–\$1,000, May 31); Roy J. Carver (typical \$6,600 at publics, 2.80 GPA, junior year, obstacles, April 1, FAFSA March 1); Ivy Finance OneApp awards with 2.5 floors (Victor; Shadle 2.5–3.0) from the ISU pack; Davis-Putter (max \$15,000; average \$7,700 in 2025–26; April 1) only if he is an active organizer in progressive movements. Not a fit at age 22 / one-semester gap: Osher Reentry (5+ year gap, typically 25–50); Horatio Alger (HS / CTE associate-certificate focus; Cloudflare blocked a full scrape — do not assume eligibility); Future Ready Iowa Grant (25+). Later-goal only: AICPA Future CPAs (accounting, 3.0 GPA; Dec 1, 2026 – Mar 15, 2027). Flag as mill/lottery: Bold.org, Niche, and Sallie no-essay sweepstakes (Sallie Mae is a loan company); any site that wants an SSN just to search; any “guaranteed scholarship” or FAFSA-for-a-fee pitch (FTC).

Finding 7 — Other education money is not a scholarship. Loans are loans. Confidence: HIGH on IRS/ED definitions

Type	What it is	Pay back?
Grant	Need-based gift (Pell, FSEOG, ISU Grant, Workforce Grant)	No, except overpayment / withdrawal
Scholarship	Merit or restricted gift (OneApp, Carver, Blue)	No, except unused-fund return
Work	FWS paycheck or regular job	You earn it
Tax credit	AOTC up to \$2,500; LLC up to \$2,000 (IRS)	N/A — reduces tax, not a check to ISU
529 / QTP	Family savings; tax-free if qualified expenses	Penalty on earnings if non-qualified; no double-dip with credits
Employer aid	Up to \$5,250/year tax-free (Pub 970 ch. 10)	No
Loan	Direct Sub/Unsub, PLUS, private	YES, with interest. 6-month Direct Loan grace after below half-time.

Table. Grant vs scholarship vs work vs tax vs loan. As of 2026-08-31.

AOTC: up to \$2,500 per eligible student, 40% refundable, first four years of postsecondary, at least half-time, MAGI phaseout \$80,000–\$90,000 single / \$160,000–\$180,000 joint (IRS education-credits page). LLC: up to \$2,000 per return, 20% of first \$10,000, unlimited years, nonrefundable. Cannot claim both for the same student in the same year. Cannot use the same expenses for a tax-free 529 distribution and a credit. Beginning tax year 2026, SSN-valid-for-work rules tighten (Pub 970). Pell is treated as a scholarship for tax purposes. Direct Loan grace: if the gap exceeds six months, repayment can start unless a deferment is granted or he re-enrolls at least half-time. Unknown whether he has loans.

3. Comparison snapshot (most relevant now)

Full comparison with URLs is in the companion Markdown. Amounts below are only those published on official pages as of 2026-08-31. Unpublished amounts are labeled unpublished — they are not estimated.

Name	Type	Amount (published)	GPA bar	When / deadline	Relevance
Pell 2026–27	Grant	Max \$7,395 / min \$740, prorated	None (SAP ~2.0)	Spring 2027 via 2026–27 FAFSA	High
Pell 2027–28	Grant	TBD early 2027	None (SAP)	FAFSA opens Oct 1, 2026	High for Fall 2027+
FSEOG	Grant	ED sheet “up to \$4,000” (Jun 2022)	Need + SAP	2026–27 priority passed; 2027–28 Jan 7, 2027	Low now / High later if need
Work-Study	Work	Varies; earned	SAP	Same ISU priority	Low now / Med 2027–28
Direct Loans	LOAN	Annual limits by class	SAP	FAFSA; half-time	Med if cash-flow — must repay
ISU Grant	Grant	Unpublished	Need	2026–27 passed; 2027–28 Jan 7, 2027	Low now / High 2027–28 if need
Cyclone Success	Grant (emergency)	Unpublished	Program-specific	After enrollment, OneApp	Med after Spring start
OneApp / Ivy Finance	Scholarship	Ivy pool ~\$3M; avg ~\$2,800 (ISU pack)	Mix; some 2.5	Opens Sep 15, 2026 (2027–28 year)	High for next year, not Spring 2027 cash
Iowa Workforce Grant	Grant	2026–27 funded \$1,125/sem FT	SAP; 60 cr; SAI ≤7,000	FAFSA Jul 1; 2026–27 missed	High for 2027–28 if gates met
Iowa Tuition Grant	Grant	2025–26 funded max \$7,500	Need / SAI	Private colleges only	NONE at ISU
Last-Dollar / Kibbie	Grant/schol.	Last-dollar / Kibbie \$3,100 (2026–27)	Need	CC / private CTE — not ISU	NONE at ISU
Future Ready Iowa Grant	Grant	See state page when 25	Age 25+	Not age 22	NONE at 22
Robert D. Blue	Scholarship	\$500–\$1,000	Evaluates HS GPA	May 31	Medium
Carver Scholars	Scholarship	Typical \$6,600 public	2.80; junior; obstacles	FAFSA Mar 1; app Apr 1	Medium later
Osher Reentry	Scholarship	Campus-set	5+ yr gap; typically 25–50	Campus	NONE now
AOTC / LLC	Tax credit	Up to \$2,500 / \$2,000	None	Tax return, Form 8863	High when paying tuition
Employer aid	Work benefit	Up to \$5,250 tax-free	Employer	Ask HR during gap	Med if employed
No-essay mills	Lottery	Advertised \$2k–\$25k	Often none	Rolling marketing	Low — not grants

Table. Comparison snapshot. Full URLs and enrollment rules are in the Markdown report. As of 2026-08-31.

4. Gap vs Spring 2027 — what to do when

This week (gap)

- StudentAid.gov: confirm 2026–27 FAFSA is on file and lists 001869. If not, file it. FAFSA is always free. Never share the FSA ID.
- Note Pell LEU (My Grants) and loan-grace status (My Loans). If a Direct Loan grace is running, write down the repayment-start date.
- Workday Academic profile: In-Progress vs Discontinued. If In-Progress after one missed fall, reentry may not be required. If Discontinued, use the undergraduate reentry application via Admissions MyAccount.
- If never admitted: apply for Spring 2027 admission now. OneApp login requires an offer.
- If academically dismissed: reinstatement is a different process; Spring 2027 petition deadline December 4, 2026.
- Do not pay a scholarship search site. Do not apply for Iowa Tuition Grant for ISU.

This fall (still gap)

- Tue Sep 15, 2026: OneApp General Application + Ivy/Finance sections. This is 2027–28 money. Applications stay editable until each opportunity closes.
- Oct 1, 2026: file 2027–28 FAFSA with 001869. Target Jan 7, 2027 if a returning student. That date also feeds Iowa Workforce Grant (state FAFSA deadline July 1, 2027 — file far earlier).
- Draft a 250–500 word obstacles/need essay usable for OneApp, Robert D. Blue, and (if eligible) Carver. Do not invent hardship.
- If working: ask HR whether a Section 127 educational-assistance plan exists (up to \$5,250 tax-free per Pub 970).
- GPA recovery: a gap semester does not raise ISU GPA. Plan Spring 2027 as a full-time, degree-applicable schedule if possible.

After Spring 2027 re-enrollment

- Enroll at least half-time (6 credits) to keep loans in school status; 12 credits if chasing full Pell / most institutional scholarships.
- If Pell-eligible, accept it. Amount will reflect spring-only + intensity.
- If an emergency expense hits, apply for Cyclone Success Assistance in OneApp.
- Complete verification by March 1 if selected and classified as a spring admit.
- Keep OneApp current (major = Finance). Ivy awards do not auto-renew.
- After a better semester: add Carver (if junior + 2.80) and the when-GPA-improves list. Do not wait on 3.5 national trophies to pay Spring 2027.

5. Contradictions, uncertainties, and gaps

Contradictions and uncertainties

- ISU current-undergrad OneApp copy is stale: it still says OneApp opened September 15, 2025. The OneApp page says it will open September 15, 2026. Use the OneApp page.
- ISU Grant page still lists 2025–26 and 2026–27 priority dates only. 2027–28 returning priority (Jan 7, 2027) is on the current-undergrad FAFSA page.
- Workforce Grant statutory max is \$2,000/sem; funded 2026–27 max is \$1,125/sem. Do not quote \$2,000 as what a student will get. 2027–28 funded amount is not posted.
- FSEOG “up to \$4,000” is from an ED PDF dated June 2022. Treat as a federal ceiling, not an offer.
- 2027–28 Pell maximum is unpublished as of 2026-08-31.
- Reentry after one semester: current undergraduate page uses two missed academic terms or a discontinued record. Check Workday; do not assume a form is or is not required.
- Returner vs first-time ISU transfer is unknown. That fork decides admission vs reentry and OneApp student type.
- Horatio Alger official page was Cloudflare-blocked; eligibility for currently enrolled bachelor’s students is not confirmed here.
- The prior ISU pack treated a possible Fall 2026 enrollment. This pack updates that: he is not enrolled Fall 2026. Incoming-transfer awards that need immediate full-time after CC are weaker, likely dead.
- X/Twitter was not searched.

Gaps (not invented)

- Personal SAI, tax filing status, dependency, citizenship, Iowa residency classification.
- GPA (ISU and transfer), credits completed (Workforce Grant 60-hour gate), SAP status, dismissal vs good standing.
- Whether 2026–27 FAFSA is already filed and whether 001869 is listed.
- Loan balances and grace clocks; leftover 529; employer tuition plan; PTK / first-gen / veteran / Guard.

- Whether ISU participates in Osher Reentry (not verified).
- Local Iowa community-foundation awards (county-specific) were not inventoried.

6. Recommended next actions

This week: FAFSA 2026–27 + 001869; Pell LEU and loan-grace check; Workday status; calendar Sep 15 and Oct 1. This fall: OneApp on Sep 15; 2027–28 FAFSA on Oct 1 aiming at Jan 7, 2027; reinstatement petition by Dec 4 only if dismissed. Spring: full-time degree-applicable credits; accept Pell; Cyclone Success only for a real shortfall; stay on SAP.

7. Sources

Numbered official and companion sources. Dates are fetch or publication dates as cited. Aggregator listicles were not used as primary.

1. Don't Miss Out on Federal Pell Grants, Federal Student Aid, fetched 2026-08-31. <https://studentaid.gov/articles/dont-miss-out-on-pell-grants/>
2. GEN-26-01, 2026–27 Federal Pell Grant Maximum and Minimum Award Amounts, U.S. Department of Education, Jan 30, 2026 (updated Feb 18, 2026). <https://fsapartners.ed.gov/knowledge-center/library/dear-colleague-letters/2026-01-30/2026-27-federal-pell-grant-maximum-and-minimum-award-amounts>
3. Free Application for Federal Student Aid (FAFSA) July 1, 2026 – June 30, 2027 (PDF), Federal Student Aid. <https://studentaid.gov/sites/default/files/2026-27-fafsa-form.pdf>
4. Federal Grant Programs fact sheet, Federal Student Aid, June 2022. <https://studentaid.gov/sites/default/files/federal-grant-programs.pdf>
5. 8 Things You Should Know About Federal Work-Study, Federal Student Aid, fetched 2026-08-31. <https://studentaid.gov/articles/8-things-federal-work-study/>
6. FAFSA Submission Summary: What You Need To Know, Federal Student Aid. <https://studentaid.gov/articles/fafsa-submission-summary/>
7. Key Facts About Your StudentAid.gov Account, Federal Student Aid. <https://studentaid.gov/articles/key-facts-accounts>
8. Federal Student Loans: Repaying Your Loans (PDF), Federal Student Aid. <https://studentaid.gov/sites/default/files/repaying-your-loans.pdf>
9. 34 CFR § 685.207 Obligation to repay (Direct Loan grace).
10. Current Undergraduate Students, ISU Office of Student Financial Aid, fetched 2026-08-31. <https://financialaid.iastate.edu/applying-for-aid/current-undergrad/>
11. First-year Students, ISU OSFA, fetched 2026-08-31. <https://financialaid.iastate.edu/applying-for-aid/new-students/>
12. OneApp Scholarship Application, ISU OSFA, fetched 2026-08-31. <https://financialaid.iastate.edu/applying-for-aid/oneapp/>
13. Iowa State University (ISU) Grant, ISU OSFA, fetched 2026-08-31. <https://financialaid.iastate.edu/types-of-aid/grants/isu-grant/>
14. Iowa State University: Priority Aid Policy, ISU OSFA, fetched 2026-08-31. <https://financialaid.iastate.edu/getting-started/qualifying-for-aid/financial-aid-policies/priority-filing-policy/>
15. Verification Document Deadline Policy, ISU OSFA.
16. Satisfactory Academic Progress (SAP) for Undergraduate Students, ISU OSFA, fetched 2026-08-31. <https://financialaid.iastate.edu/managing-your-aid/sap/undergraduate-students/>
17. Courses Toward Degree Completion Policy, ISU OSFA, fetched 2026-08-31.
18. Cyclone Success Assistance, ISU OSFA, fetched 2026-08-31. <https://financialaid.iastate.edu/tools-and-resources/cyclone-success-assistance/>
19. Reentry, Returning, and Reinstatement Students, ISU Registrar, fetched 2026-08-31. <https://www.registrar.iastate.edu/students/reentry>
20. Reentering or Returning Undergraduate Students, ISU Registrar, fetched 2026-08-31. <https://www.registrar.iastate.edu/students/reentry/undergraduate-students>
21. Reinstatement after Academic Dismissal, ISU Registrar. Spring 2027 petition deadline December 4, 2026.
22. Scholarships & Grants (Iowa), Iowa Department of Education / Iowa College Aid, fetched 2026-08-31. <https://educate.iowa.gov/higher-ed/financial-aid/scholarships-grants>
23. Iowa Workforce Grant & Incentive Program, Iowa DOE, fetched 2026-08-31. <https://educate.iowa.gov/higher-ed/financial-aid/scholarships-grants/workforce-grant>
24. 2025–26 and 2026–27 Workforce Grant Programs of Study, Iowa DOE, updated June 6, 2025. Includes ISU Finance, B.S. <https://educate.iowa.gov/media/10073/download?inline=>
25. Iowa Tuition Grant, Iowa DOE, fetched 2026-08-31. Private colleges only. <https://educate.iowa.gov/higher-ed/financial-aid/scholarships-grants/iowa-tuition-grant>
26. Future Ready Iowa Last-Dollar Scholarship, Iowa DOE, fetched 2026-08-31.

27. Future Ready Iowa Grant, Iowa DOE, fetched 2026-08-31. Age 25+.
28. Kibbie Grant, Iowa DOE, fetched 2026-08-31. Iowa community colleges.
29. All Iowa Opportunity Scholarship, Iowa DOE, fetched 2026-08-31.
30. Robert D. Blue Scholarship, Iowa DOE, fetched 2026-08-31. \$500–\$1,000; May 31.
31. Iowa Admin. Code 283—16 (Future Ready Iowa Skilled Workforce Grant), age 25.
32. Prospective Applicants, Roy J. Carver Charitable Trust, fetched 2026-08-31. <https://carvertrust.org/scholarships/prospective-applicants/>
33. Osher Scholars and Fellows Program, The Bernard Osher Foundation, fetched 2026-08-31. <https://www.osherfoundation.org/scholars.html>
34. AICPA Foundation Scholarship for Future CPAs, ThisWayToCPA / AICPA, fetched 2026-08-31.
35. Davis-Putter Scholarship 2026 application, Davis-Putter Scholarship Fund.
36. Education credits — AOTC and LLC, Internal Revenue Service, fetched 2026-08-31.
<https://www.irs.gov/credits-deductions/individuals/education-credits-aotc-llc>
37. Publication 970 (2025), Tax Benefits for Education, IRS, fetched 2026-08-31. <https://www.irs.gov/publications/p970>
38. How To Avoid Scholarship and Financial Aid Scams, Federal Trade Commission, May 2021, fetched 2026-08-31.
<https://consumer.ftc.gov/articles/how-avoid-scholarship-and-financial-aid-scams>
39. OneApp portal. <https://iastate.academicworks.com>
40. FAFSA. <https://studentaid.gov/h/apply-for-aid/fafsa>
41. Companion pack (continuity): Research Report — Iowa State Scholarships for Evan Symons, 2026-08-31.

Not used as primary: Bold.org, Niche, Sallie Mae no-essay pages, Fastweb/Scholarships.com listicles, stop-out blogs. X/Twitter: not searched this session.